

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

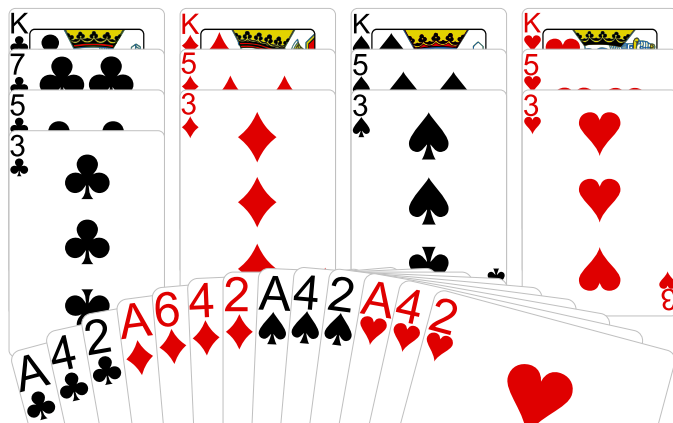
*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 2NT Goal: at least ____ winners



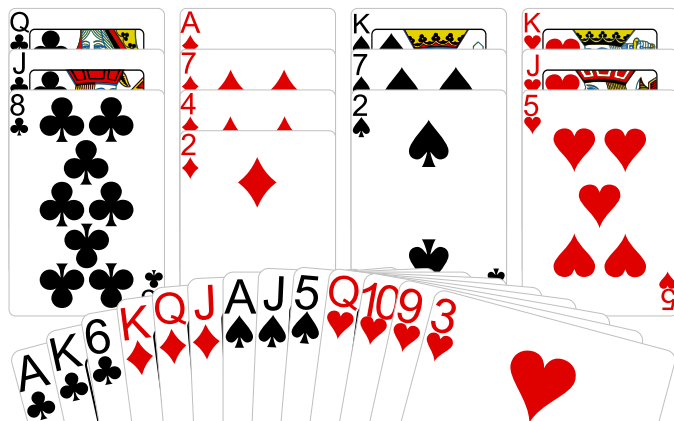
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



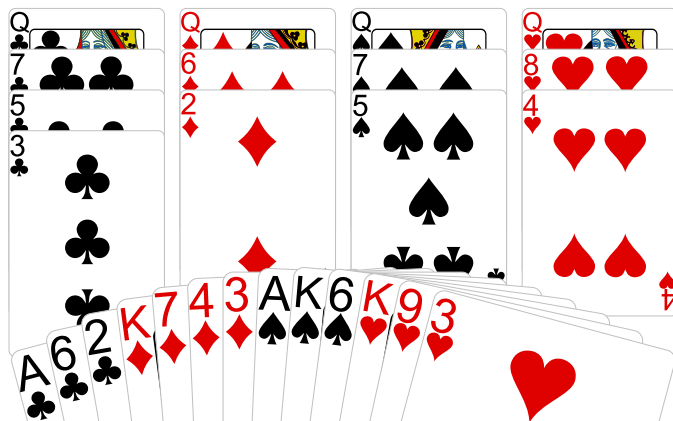
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: West

Deal 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A 4 2
♥ Q T 8 4
♦ T 8
♣ 9 7 6 4

21
6 10
3

♠ Q J T
♥ A J 7
♦ A K 6 2
♣ K Q J



♠ K 8 3
♥ 9 6 5 2
♦ 7 4 3
♣ 8 5 2

♠ 9 7 6 5
♥ K 3
♦ Q J 9 5
♣ A T 3

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With 21 points and 4-3-3-3 distribution,
NORTH opens 2NT.

SOUTH has just 3 points; he knows that
NORTH cannot have more than 21 so the
partnership

total cannot be more than 24. So he just passes
2NT.

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			
2NT by North			

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 5 3
♥ K 5 3
♦ K 5 3
♣ K 7 5 3

5
12 16
7

♠ 8 7 6

♥ 9 8 7 6

♦ Q T 7

♣ Q J 6



♠ Q J T 9

♥ Q J T

♦ J 9 8

♣ T 9 8

♠ A 4 2

♥ A 4 2

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ A 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

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This is an easy one to bid.

EAST has a balanced 16 points so he opens 1NT.

WEST has a balanced 12 points so she responds 3NT.

BUT - just look at how this would play. You might only be able to take 8 tricks.

Sometimes correct bidding gets you to unmakeable contracts. But it's only a game.

Deal 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6 4
♥ 8 7 6 4
♦ T 5
♣ 9 7 4 2

14
2 4
20

♠ K 7 2
♥ K J 5
♦ A 7 4 2
♣ Q J 8



♠ A J 5
♥ Q T 9 3
♦ K Q J
♣ A K 6

♠ T 9 8 3
♥ A 2
♦ 9 8 6 3
♣ T 5 3

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Notrump bidding really is easy, you just add your points to partner's points and then

bid according to that answer.

Here NORTH has 14 points. So when SOUTH opens 2NT, showing 20 or 21 points NORTH knows the

total will come to 34 or 35 so he bids 6NT.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	2NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 6
♥ K 9 3
♦ K 7 4 3
♣ A 6 2

9
17 8
6

♠ J T 9 2
♥ A J 7 5 2
♦ T 8
♣ K 9



♠ 8 4 3
♥ T 6
♦ A J 9 5
♣ J T 8 4

♠ Q 7 5
♥ Q 8 4
♦ Q 6 2
♣ Q 7 5 3

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EAST cannot open with only 8 points.

Furthermore, when WEST opens 1NT EAST knows that the partnership has a 25 points at most so

he passes again.

West

North

East
Pass

South
Pass

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West